

Optimizing audience campaigns

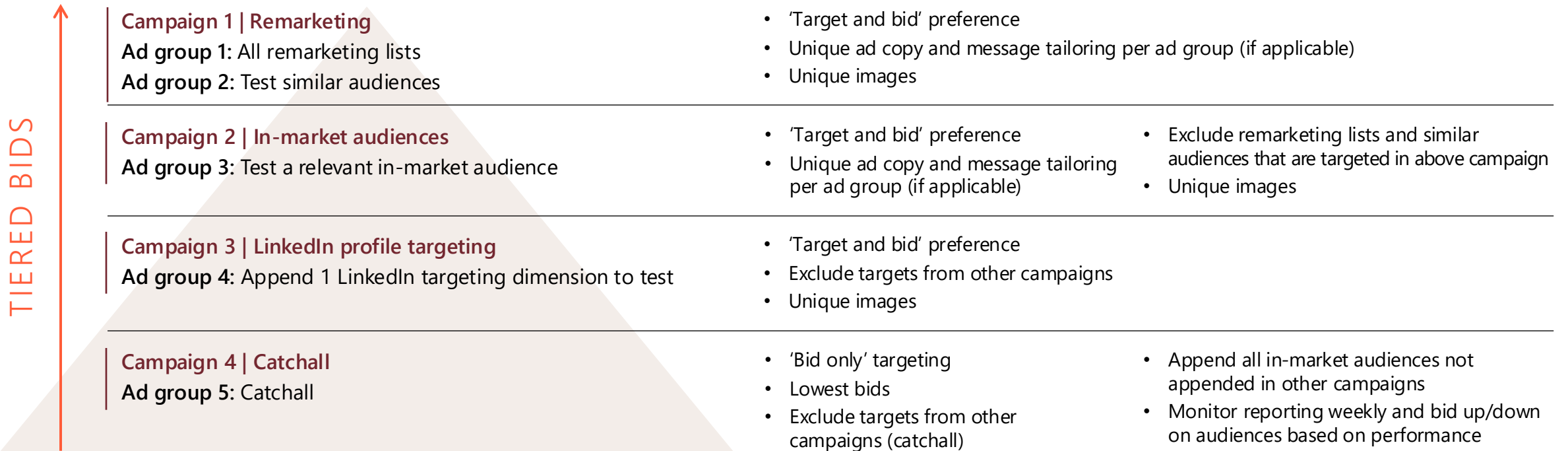
Tips and best practices
Audience ads

 Microsoft Advertising



Before you optimize, make sure you have the ideal campaign structure

Keep it simple, fill your marketing funnel



Optimization timeline



Search workflow simplified set up and optimization checklist

01

Adding images is the most important optimization you can make. This not only helps performance but protects you from seeing annotations that are not appropriate for your brand. Test multiple image assets and ad copy variations and ensure relevancy.

02

We recommend you to optimize for your search campaigns and your audience campaign will benefit from these optimizations.

03

Review our [View-Through Conversion](#) report to better understand the performance of your campaign. Our default for view-through conversions is 1 day, please ensure the default works with your marketing goals and adjust accordingly.

04

Exclude any domains that are underperforming. Be cautious about how that will impact the traffic of your campaign.

05

Pull out top performing audiences and remarketing into own audience campaign for better control and performance.

Audience campaign simplified optimization checklist

01

Make sure you have **conversion, impression and click-tracking** set up and review it regularly.

02

Use our **bid landscape tool** to ensure your bids are competitive enough to win volume. Don't bid aggressively everywhere. Focus on a few increased bids and see how they perform.

03

Review our [Share Of Voice reporting \(SOV\)](#) and [View-through conversion \(VTC\) reporting](#) to measure the full value of your campaign and understand how it is positioned against the competition. Both SOV and VTC reporting can be found directly in our Microsoft Advertising UI by modifying the column metric.

04

Test multiple assets and ensure ad copy relevancy. We recommend keeping their existing creative live for a few days until they ramp but also refreshing them every 30 days or so to avoid user fatigue.

05

Experiment with new audiences utilizing the [Audience Planner](#) and our full array of audience targeting features. There is no one-size-fits-all solution, and the marketplace is constantly changing with placements and audiences. If one structure/audience, doesn't work, test again.

06

Exclude any domains that are underperforming. Be cautious about how that will impact the traffic of your campaign.

Audience campaign optimizations by campaign type

Image-based optimization tips

LOW VOLUME?

1. For all campaigns, please ensure they are okay to run on Audience ads. Our full policy can be found [here](#). Not policy? Continue to the below.
2. Check to see if there are any audience or account level exclusions.
3. Check the size of your audience being targeted via the [Audience Planner tool](#) in the Microsoft Advertising UI.
4. Are your bids competitive enough?
 - Check our Bid Landscape tool, [Audience Planner tool](#) and [Share of Voice reporting](#) in the Microsoft Advertising UI.
5. Do you get enough site traffic?
 - Check your remarketing or similar audience list sizes.

LOW PERFORMANCE?

1. Check device performance.
 - Is smartphone traffic taking up all your spend?
 - Bid adjust down smartphone.
 - Are specific publishers causing poor performance?
 - Exclude publishers.
2. Are your bids competitive enough to scale?
 - Check our Bid Landscape tool, [Audience Planner tool](#) and [Share of Voice reporting](#) in the Microsoft Advertising UI
3. Campaigns capping early in the day?
 - Daypart the campaign to the regular waking hours.
4. Are you seeing creative fatigue or poor performing ads?
 - Try adding in new creatives to help increase CTR and CVR.

Video-based optimization tips

LOW VOLUME?

1. For all campaigns, please ensure they are okay to run Audience ads. Our full policy can be found [here](#). Not policy? Continue to the below.
 - Remember Video is currently only available on O&O, so your ads must be eligible to serve there to see delivery.
2. Check the size of your audience being targeted via the [Audience Network Planner tool](#) in the Microsoft Advertising UI
3. Are your bids competitive enough?
4. Do you get enough site traffic?
 - Check your remarketing or similar audience list sizes—make sure the UET tag is appended properly as well.

LOW PERFORMANCE?

1. Are your bids competitive enough to scale?
2. Campaigns capping early in the day?
 - Daypart the campaign to the regular waking hours.
3. Are you seeing creative fatigue or poor performing ads?
 - Try adding in new video creatives to help increase VTR.
4. Test different bid strategies. Video now available in CPV, CPM and CPC pricing models (CPC not recommended until more inventory is available yielding higher CTR).
5. Consider highlighting view-through conversions in reporting. Since Video should primarily be utilized as an awareness tactic, view-through metrics can help show the full impact of the campaign.

Standard feed-based campaigns

LOW VOLUME?

1. For all campaigns, please ensure they are okay on Audience ads. Our full policy can be found [here](#). Not policy? Continue to the below.
2. Check to see if you've set any audience exclusions or any audiences to 'Target and bid'
 - Any audiences appended to a feed-based campaign should be 'Bid only'.
3. Are your bids competitive enough?
 - Check our Bid Landscape tool, [Audience Planner tool](#) and [Share of Voice reporting](#) in the Microsoft Advertising UI
4. Do you get enough site traffic?
 - Check your remarketing lists sizes in the Share Library.
5. Check with our Ad Support team if the URL patterns can't be auto-detected by the system and need custom adjustments.

POOR PERFORMANCE?

1. Check device type
 - Is smartphone traffic taking up all your spend?
 - Bid adjust down smartphone.
2. Are specific publishers causing poor performance?
 - Exclude publishers if applicable.
3. Demographic
 - Bid adjust down on poor performing demographics.
 - Bid adjust up on demographics that are hitting goal.

Dynamic remarketing campaigns

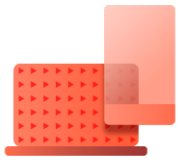
LOW VOLUME?

1. For all campaigns, please ensure they are okay on Audience ads. Our full policy can be found [here](#). Not policy? Continue to the below.
2. What are the user pool sizes for their dynamic remarketing lists?
3. Do you have any exclusions or additional segments appended?
4. Is your UET++ tag set up properly and do we have a tag set up on each page?
 - Open a ticket with our Ad Support team to QA that product IDs are passing back properly.

POOR PERFORMANCE?

1. Check device type.
 - Is smartphone traffic taking up all your spend?
 - Bid adjust down smartphone.
2. Are specific publishers causing poor performance?
 - Exclude publishers if applicable.
3. Do you have a strong 1:1 ad group/dynamic remarketing segment structure in place?
 - Ad Group 1 = Cart Abandoners,
 - Ad Group 2 = Past buyers etc.

Top ways to optimize your Audience campaigns



Devices



Audience targets



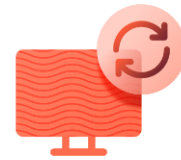
Day-parting
(time of day/day
of week)



Ad group bids



Creative



Partner sites

Thank you